Brazil

Although not active in Zimbabwe in any major mining investments, just over the eastern border, the Brazilian mining company Vale has a large coal project whose operations have raised serious concern among the affected communities. The company displaced over 700 Mozambican families in Cateme, who are now being controlled by the police after violent repression occurred at a community protest in 2012.

Angered by Vale's failure to keep the promises made before the relocation in 2009, and the lacklustre response by the national and provincial government to their problems, over 700 families living in Cateme gave the company and authorities an ultimatum in December 2011 for them to address their demands by 10 January the following year. Otherwise, they warned that they would mobilise.

On the eve of 10 January, over 600 people blocked the rails and roads of the area. Police responded by violently suppressing the demonstration, resulting in several injuries. In addition, 14 people were arrested, according to the Maputo environmental-justice NGO Justiça Ambiental, and several were tortured while in prison.

Today these Vale victims live without basic services, according to activist Jeremias Vunjanhe, of Justiça Ambiental /Friends of the Earth Mozambique in an interview with Real World Radio. Human Rights Watch noted that 'in many cases the people lost the ability to grow food and ended up relying on the foreign coal companies for handouts'.

Vale is the world's largest producer of iron ore and pellets, a key raw material for the iron and steel industry, and the second largest producer of nickel. Since 2007, the company has owned the concession of a coal extraction project in Moatize, an area considered to be one of the world's largest reservoirs of coal. The project has been severely criticised by some national groups, among other things because 1300 families had to be displaced. In addition to the Cateme relocation centre, the September 25th Centre is home to 500 families.

Vunjane told Real World Radio that Cateme inhabitants lack access to water, to land for agriculture and to transportation to get medical attention. The issue of transportation is extremely urgent as residents regularly need to be transported to the provincial hospital in Vila de Moatize, 40 kilometres away. Cateme's Health Centre can only meet some basic needs.

The population of this area understands that the relocation process was ill-managed and they complain about Vale's broken promises, among them the promise to maintain their homes for the first five years of the project. They also demand the establishment of a water channel system that can ensure access to